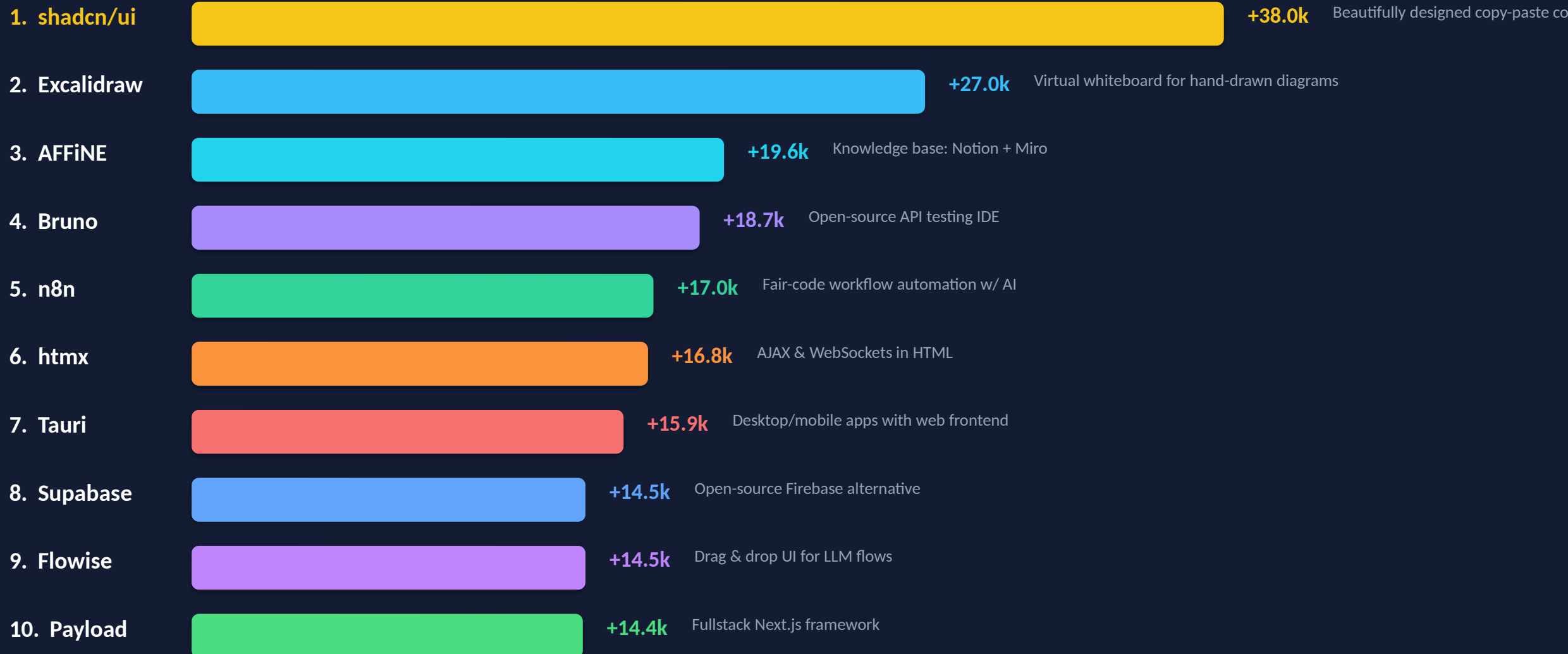

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

9th Edition • Methodology: GitHub stars added in 2024 for projects curated by Best of JS

For frontend engineers & engineering managers tracking JavaScript ecosystem trends

Overall Top 10: shadcn/ui Leads with +38k Stars



shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the 2nd Year

Year-over-Year Star Growth

2016–2022	N/A
2023	+39.5k
2024	+38.0k

Total: 77.5k stars • Created January 2023

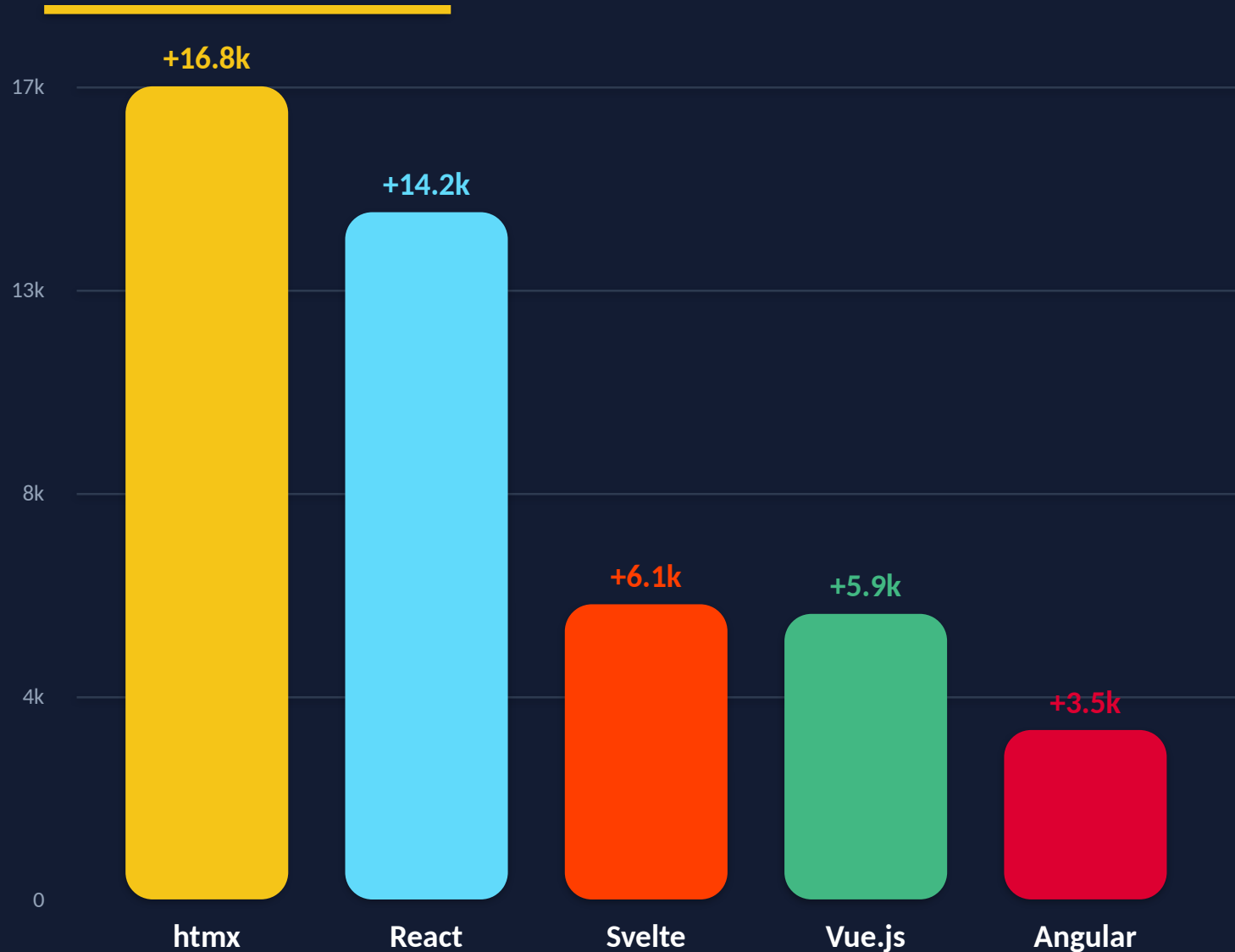
Key 2024 Additions

- ▶ Charts — powered by Recharts
- ▶ Themes — CSS variable generation
- ▶ Blocks — layout collections for web apps
- ▶ Responsive Sidebar component
- ▶ Upgraded CLI: Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos

Why It Wins

- Own the code: copy-paste model lets developers fully customize components — no black-box dependency
- Registry ecosystem: CLI supports importing from any compatible registry → spawning derivative libraries (Motion-Primitives, Magic UI)
- AI synergy: integration with Vercel's v0 for AI-generated components accelerated adoption
- Multi-framework: CLI now supports Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, and monorepos

Frontend Frameworks: htmx Overtakes React as #1



htmx — HTML-First

Extends HTML with `hx-*` attributes for data fetching & interactivity — no JS required. Ideal for server-driven apps.

Rose from #2 (2023) → #1 (2024)

React 19 — 3 Years in the Making

Server Components, Server Functions, Custom Elements support, new hooks, form actions.

Evolving from a library into "a specification for frameworks"

— Robin Wieruch

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

1

shadcn/ui

Copy-paste component library

+38.0k

2

Excalidraw

Virtual whiteboard

+27.0k

3

Payload

Fullstack Next.js framework

+14.4k

4

Magic UI

Animated UI components

+13.2k

5

Next.js

React meta-framework

+12.1k

React's Evolution

React is evolving from a library into a specification for frameworks.

With React 19's Server Components and Server Functions, frameworks like Next.js and Remix interpret React's primitives differently.

The React Compiler continues development to improve performance and DX.

This "framework spec" model means React knowledge transfers across multiple runtimes — but also means choosing a framework matters more than ever.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead

#1 Nuxt

Vue meta-framework

+6.2k

#2 PrimeVue

Rich UI component suite

+5.4k

#3 Slidev

Presentation slides for devs

+4.7k

#4 shadcn-vue

shadcn/ui port for Vue

+4.1k

#5 VitePress

Static site generator

+3.7k

Vue 3.5 & Beyond

Vue 3.5 reworked the reactivity system — the lighter alien-signals approach has already landed in the main branch.

The flourishing of Vue UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) signals growing ecosystem confidence.

Daniel Roe (Nuxt core lead) highlighted the active release cycle and regular performance improvements.

Svelte 5 introduced "runes" for reactive state — highest positive opinion in State of JS survey.

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser Innovation Shape 2024

AI-Powered Tools

n8n

Workflow automation with native AI

+17.0k stars in 2024

Flowise

Visual drag & drop LLM flow builder

+14.5k stars in 2024

Supabase

Open-source BaaS with AI features

+14.5k stars in 2024

AFFiNE

Knowledge base with AI capabilities

+19.6k stars in 2024

Desktop / Mobile

Tauri

Lighter desktop & mobile apps with web tech

+15.9k stars in 2024

Browser Innovation

PGlite

Postgres running via WebAssembly

WebVM

Full virtual machine in the browser

4 of the top 10 overall projects have significant AI capabilities or integrations

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

1

Component ownership beats imports

shadcn/ui's copy-paste model proved its staying power for a 2nd year, reaching 77.5k total stars. Own the code, customize freely.

2

HTML-first is serious

htmx overtook React as #1 frontend framework by stars added — server-driven, low-JS architectures are gaining real traction.

3

React is becoming a framework spec

Server Components & Server Functions mean Next.js, Remix, etc. interpret React differently. Choosing a framework matters more than ever.

4

AI integration is table stakes

4 of the top 10 projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities. If you're building tools, AI integration is expected.

5

Vue's ecosystem signals maturity

A wave of high-quality UI libraries + Vue 3.5 reactivity overhaul signal a confident, maturing ecosystem worth evaluating.

Looking ahead to 2025 → Watch for AI-native tooling, continued framework consolidation, and WebAssembly breakthroughs